

MEDICAL POLICY AHP-SPX-118

Anvara Health Plan | Interleukin-23 Inhibitors for Plaque Psoriasis | Effective 2026-01-01

SCOPE

This policy establishes the medical necessity criteria applied by Anvara Health Plan to requests for interleukin-23 inhibitors for plaque psoriasis for commercial plan members. It applies to requests submitted directly by a prescriber and to requests submitted by an authorised manufacturer hub agent on the prescriber's behalf.

DRUGS REQUIRING PRIOR AUTHORIZATION

Prior authorization is required for products billed under the following codes: J3592. J3592 corresponds to velunekimab, marketed as Velunexa, 150 mg/ml single-dose pre-filled syringe.

DRUGS NOT REQUIRING PRIOR AUTHORIZATION

Topical corticosteroids, topical vitamin D analogues, and office-based narrowband UVB phototherapy do not require prior authorization under this plan.

MEDICAL NECESSITY CRITERIA

Velunexa is considered medically necessary when all of the following criteria are met:

1. The patient has a confirmed diagnosis of moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis with body surface area involvement of at least 10 percent or a PASI score of at least 12, documented by the treating clinician.
2. The patient is 18 years of age or older.
3. The patient has completed a trial of at least twelve (12) weeks of one conventional systemic agent (methotrexate, cyclosporine, or acitretin) or a documented course of phototherapy, without clinically meaningful improvement, unless every available agent is contraindicated or not tolerated.
4. Tuberculosis screening has been completed within the twelve (12) months preceding initiation and the result is negative, or a positive result has been evaluated and treated.
5. The drug is prescribed by, or in documented consultation with, a dermatologist or rheumatologist.

EXCEPTIONS

The conservative systemic therapy requirement is waived where the patient has documented hepatic impairment, is pregnant or planning pregnancy, has a history of malignancy within five years, or where all conventional systemic agents are contraindicated. The prescriber must state the contraindication in the medical record.

DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

Submitted requests must include the signed prescriber enrollment or start form, a statement of medical necessity, a clinical note documenting disease severity and body surface area, documentation of the conventional systemic therapy course and its outcome, and tuberculosis screening results dated within twelve months.

REVIEW TIMEFRAMES

Standard requests are adjudicated within five (5) business days of receipt of a complete submission. Expedited requests are adjudicated within seventy-two (72) hours. An incomplete submission is returned with a written statement of the missing element and the review clock restarts on receipt of the complete packet.

CODING

CODE	TYPE	DESCRIPTION
J3592	HCPCS	Velunekimab, per billing unit
58291-0150-01	NDC	Velunexa 150 mg/mL single-dose pre-filled syringe
L40.0	ICD-10-CM	Psoriasis vulgaris

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